

The role of reviews and ratings in healthcare

Their responsible and effective use has the **potential** to **revolutionise** healthcare positively and ensure maximum benefits for the patients

The COVID-19 pandemic has reshaped the healthcare **landscape** globally, exposing the **vulnerabilities** in the healthcare system and **emphasizing** the need for digital transformation. In the post-pandemic **era**, healthcare providers **grapple with** the challenge of **meeting** increasing demand while **upholding** the highest standards of care. In this context, reviews and ratings (R&R) have emerged as crucial tools, providing **transparency**, **accountability**, and patient-centric care, essential for making informed healthcare decisions.

In the **contemporary** world, **access** to online information about healthcare providers **is** **integral**. Without such resources, patients would **navigate** a complex healthcare system with **minimal** knowledge about a doctor's **credentials** and patient feedback. They will have to **rely** solely on recommendations from friends and relatives. This **scenario underscores** the importance of R&R in **facilitating** informed decision-making.

The **significance** of reviews and ratings **lies** in their power to offer **transparency** into the quality of healthcare services. Found on various platforms, including healthcare provider websites and social media, these tools allow patients to share experiences and rate services, clinics, and providers. They provide transparency into the quality of care, **empowering** patients to make informed decisions about where to seek care.

Healthcare providers are increasingly aware that their performance is under public **scrutiny** and recognise the impact of reviews and ratings. Positive feedback reflects excellent care, while negative reviews **prompt** improvements. This makes them more **accountable** and **fosters** an environment where providers continuously enhance the patient experience and quality of care.

Globally, many developed nations utilise online reviews and ratings to guide healthcare choices. Systems in the US, UK, Germany, the Netherlands, and Australia provide patients with essential information to build confidence in their healthcare providers.

Access to online information enables patients to choose healthcare providers based on their unique needs and knowledge, reducing the risk of **subpar** care. This **empowerment** of patients **enhances** decision-making, contributing to better healthcare outcomes. Moreover, the **surge** in **telehealth adoption** post-pandemic **has** seen reviews and ratings play a crucial role in building trust in **virtual** healthcare services.

However, challenges exist, such as fake reviews and **biased** ratings can mislead patients and **tarnish** a provider's reputation. At the same time, patients can make their decision solely based on reviews without considering their specific requirement. This makes education on interpreting reviews crucial

for patients. Also, it **underscores** the significance of integrating **robust** verification processes for review givers to ensure the authenticity of the review.

To **gauge** the significance of online ratings and reviews in the selection of healthcare providers - I ran a 24-hour poll on Twitter (now X) and asked the following question: Are online ratings and reviews important from other patients while choosing a doctor? In the over 1000 voluntary responses, the **overwhelming** majority of **respondents** said, "Yes". This result was statistically significant ($p=0.001$) indicating that online ratings and reviews are important when choosing a doctor. India, **in particular**, can lead by establishing a robust R&R platform to promote fair healthcare. The **vision** of integrating technology as a **catalyst** for transformative change **aligns with** the evolving healthcare landscape. All **stakeholders** must **collaborate** to ensure the accuracy, dependability, and accessibility of online healthcare information, benefiting patients universally.

- **Surge** (noun) – Increase, upsurge, escalation, spike, growth उछाल
- **Telehealth** (noun) – the distribution of health-related services and information via electronic information and telecommunication technologies.
- **Adoption** (noun) – Acceptance, implementation, espousal, embracing
- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

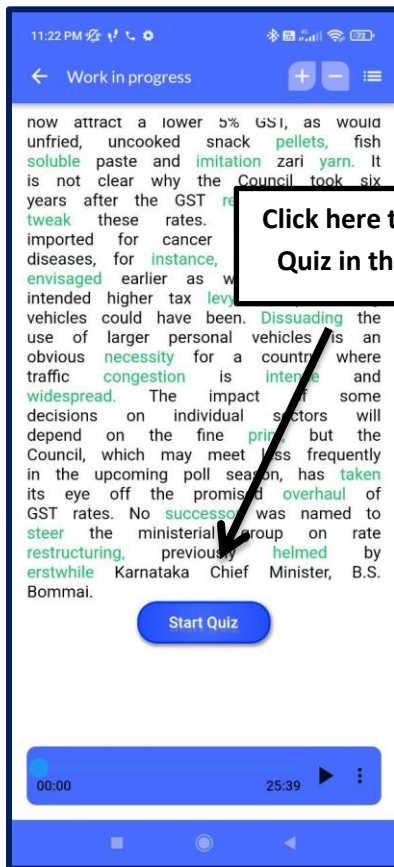
1. **Potential** (noun) – Capability, capacity, power, ability, promise संभावना/ सामर्थ्य
2. **Revolutionise** (verb) – Transform, overhaul, reform, reshape, remodel क्रांति लाना
3. **Landscape** (noun) – Terrain, scenery, environment, setting, backdrop परिदृश्य
4. **Vulnerability** (noun) – Susceptibility, weakness, fragility, sensitivity, exposure कमजोरी
5. **Emphasise** (verb) – Highlight, stress, underline, accentuate, underscore बल देना
6. **Era** (noun) – Period, epoch, age, time, phase युग
7. **Grapple** (with) (verb) – Wrestle, struggle, contend, cope, deal से जूझना
8. **Meet** (verb) – Fulfill, satisfy, answer, comply, adhere पूरा करना
9. **Uphold** (verb) – Support, maintain, defend, sustain, endorse कायम रखना
10. **Transparency** (noun) – Clarity, openness, lucidity, candor, straightforwardness पारदर्शिता
11. **Accountability** (noun) – Responsibility, answerability, liability, obligation, duty जवाबदेही
12. **Contemporary** (adjective) – Modern, current, present-day, up-to-date, recent समकालीन
13. **Integral** (adjective) – Essential, fundamental, necessary, vital, indispensable अभिन्न
14. **Navigate** (verb) – Steer, direct, maneuver, pilot, guide संचालन करना
15. **Minimal** (adjective) – Least, minimum, slightest, smallest, negligible न्यूनतम
16. **Credential** (noun) – achievement, quality, or aspect of a person's background
17. **Rely** (on) (verb) – Depend, trust, lean, count, bank निर्भर होना
18. **Scenario** (noun) – Situation, case, circumstance, condition, context परिदृश्य
19. **Underscore** (verb) – Underline, emphasize, highlight, accentuate, stress जोर देना
20. **Facilitate** (verb) – Ease, assist, enable, aid, simplify सुगम बनाना
21. **Lie** (in) (verb) – Reside, exist, consist, dwell, inhabit निहित होना
22. **Transparency** (noun) – Clarity, openness, lucidity, candor, straightforwardness पारदर्शिता
23. **Empower** (verb) – Authorize, enable, permit, allow, license सशक्त बनाना
24. **Scrutiny** (noun) – Examination, inspection, analysis, review, investigation जांच

25. **Prompt** (verb) – Induce, motivate, provoke, trigger, stimulate प्रेरित करना
26. **Accountable** (adjective) – Responsible, answerable, liable, amenable, chargeable जवाबदेह
27. **Foster** (verb) – Encourage, promote, nurture, cultivate, develop प्रोत्साहित करना
28. **Subpar** (adjective) – Inferior, below average, substandard, poor, deficient घटिया
29. **Empowerment** (noun) – Authorization, enablement, liberation, emancipation, freedom सशक्तिकरण
30. **Enhance** (verb) – Improve, augment, boost, amplify, heighten बढ़ाना
31. **Virtual** (adjective) – Digital, online, electronic
32. **Biased** (adjective) – Prejudiced, partial, one-sided, slanted, skewed पक्षपातपूर्ण
33. **Tarnish** (verb) – Discolor, stain, blemish, taint, sully धूमिल करना
34. **Underscore** (verb) – Underline, emphasize, highlight, accent, stress जोर देना
35. **Robust** (adjective) – Strong, sturdy, tough, powerful, durable मजबूत
36. **Gauge** (verb) – Measure, assess, evaluate, estimate, appraise नापना
37. **Overwhelming** (adjective) – very large, profuse, enormous, immense, inordinate भारी
38. **Respondent** (noun) – Answerer, replier, respondent, respondent in a survey प्रतिवादी
39. **In particular** (phrase) – Specifically, particularly, especially, notably, expressly विशेष रूप से
40. **Catalyst** (noun) – Stimulus, spur, impetus, incentive, motivator उत्प्रेरक
41. **Align with** (phrasal verb) – Coordinate with, synchronize with, conform to, match, integrate with संरेखित करना
42. **Stakeholder** (noun) – Participant, shareholder, investor, interested party, party involved हितधारक
43. **Collaborate** (verb) – Cooperate, work together, join forces, team up, partner सहयोग करना

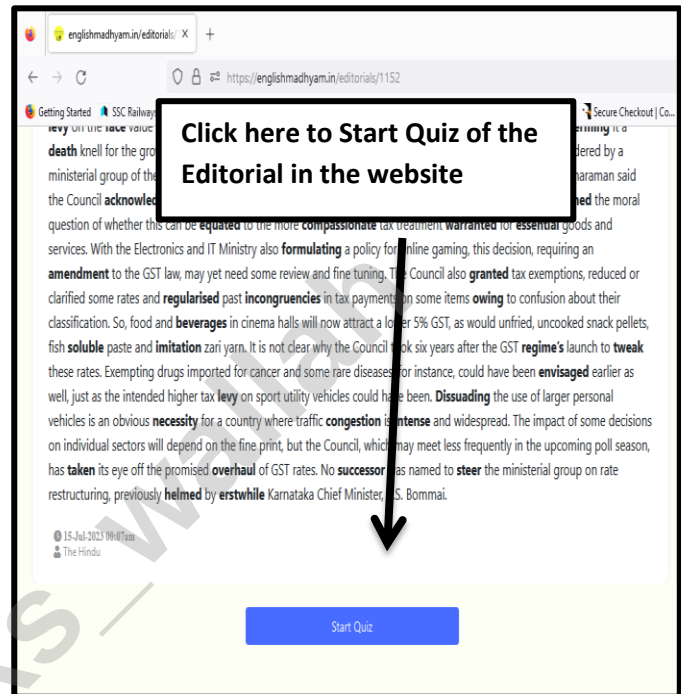
Summary of the Editorial

1. Reviews and ratings (R&R) in healthcare have gained prominence post-COVID-19, offering transparency and aiding in informed healthcare decisions.
2. The pandemic highlighted the need for digital transformation in healthcare, revealing system vulnerabilities and increasing demand for online information.
3. R&R provide crucial insights into healthcare providers, allowing patients to bypass traditional reliance on personal recommendations.
4. These tools offer transparency into healthcare service quality through patient experiences and ratings on various platforms.
5. Healthcare providers recognize the impact of public scrutiny via R&R, prompting them to improve services and enhance patient care.
6. Developed nations like the US, UK, Germany, the Netherlands, and Australia use R&R extensively to guide patient choices and build confidence in healthcare services.
7. R&R empower patients to make informed decisions based on individual needs, improving healthcare outcomes and trust, especially in telehealth services post-pandemic.
8. Challenges include the presence of fake reviews and biased ratings, which can mislead patients and damage providers' reputations.
9. Patients may overly rely on reviews without considering personal healthcare needs, highlighting the need for education on interpreting R&R.
10. Ensuring the authenticity of reviews through robust verification processes for reviewers is crucial to maintain trust and reliability.
11. A poll on Twitter confirmed the significance of R&R in choosing healthcare providers, with the majority recognizing their importance.
12. The poll result, statistically significant ($p=0.001$), indicates a strong reliance on R&R in healthcare decision-making processes.
13. India has the potential to lead in establishing a robust R&R platform, promoting equitable healthcare and integrating technology for transformative change.
14. Collaboration among stakeholders is necessary to ensure the accuracy, dependability, and accessibility of online healthcare information.
15. In conclusion, responsible and effective use of R&R can revolutionize healthcare, ensuring transparency, accountability, and patient-centric care.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



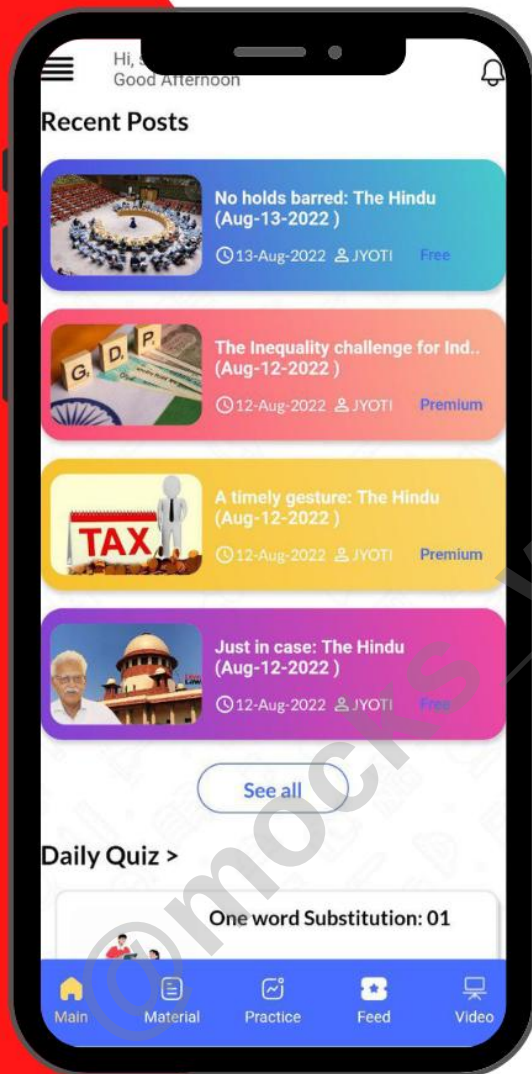
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